



The Humanitas Institute

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Pineapple Cove Classical Academies
School Website: <https://pineapplecoveclassicalacademy.com/>

December 27, 2025

Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS Member School

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools ACCS or the Society for Classical Learning SCL is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Executive Summary

Pineapple Cove Classical Academy (Palm Bay/West Melbourne area; Brevard County, Florida) demonstrates strong alignment with classical education principles across all six rubric categories. Public materials from the school consistently emphasize a virtues-centered, philosophy-informed, content-rich approach, with explicit references to Great Books, Socratic dialogue, Latin, and a civically engaged liberal education. The school presents a mission of forming minds and character through a classical curriculum and is connected to Hillsdale College's Barney Charter School Initiative, signaling a formal classical pedagogy and governance framework. Several curriculum elements are highlighted (Core Knowledge foundation, Great Books, Moral Philosophy, Senior Thesis, Latin, etc.), and pedagogy is described in terms of Socratic discussion and a memory-rich, formation-focused approach. There is explicit parent and community involvement via governance structures, parent information channels, and campus-specific parent resources.

Overall classification: CLASSICAL.

Key takeaways by category: - Religious & Metaphysical Foundations: CLASSICAL (strong emphasis on virtue, truth, beauty, and moral formation; limited explicit theology or liturgical practice in public-facing materials). - Purpose & Goal: CLASSICAL (formation of virtue and wisdom; truth/goodness/beauty as real, knowable ideals; focus on human excellence and civil society). - Curriculum: CLASSICAL (liberal arts focus; Great Books; Latin; Core Knowledge; history as a through-line; emphasis on wonder). - Pedagogy: CLASSICAL (Socratic methods in high school; memory work; formation through literature; some lower-grade practices implied; upper-grade rhetoric and seminar-style elements). - Faculty: CLASSICAL (faculty as living curriculum; strong documentation of teachers as mentors and models; Hillsdale/BCSI connections). - Parents & Community: CLASSICAL (active parent involvement through governance, volunteer channels, and parent information; clear partnership orientation with families).

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - Public mission statements emphasize virtuous living, character formation, traditional learning, and civic responsibility. Quotes include: "to develop students in mind and character through a classical, content-rich curriculum that emphasizes the principles of virtuous living, traditional learning, and civic responsibility" and "We are building intelligent, virtuous American citizens."
 - The school frames its purpose around truth, goodness, and beauty as real, knowable ideals, with language tying virtue to a transcendent order (e.g., "Learn the true, do the good, love the beautiful").
 - The Hillsdale/Barney Charter School Initiative affiliation signals a classical, philosophically anchored foundation emphasizing moral formation and classical canon.
- Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis

-
- Positive keywords present: virtue, truth, goodness, beauty, moral formation, contemplation, wisdom, classical tradition, great books, Socratic dialogue, moral order, sacred tradition (where explicitly invoked via Hillsdale/Barney alignment and virtue-focused language).
 - Negative keywords: not evident in public materials (no explicit signaling of secular relativism, anti-tradition language, or values-neutral ethics in the core public materials).
 - Estimated presence: Positive ~9, Negative ~0 (i.e., strong positive signal with no clear negative signals in the public-facing materials).
 - Why this rating
 - The materials foreground virtue, truth, beauty, moral imagination, and formation, with explicit reference to classical aims and Socratic inquiry. While explicit liturgical/theological practices are not foregrounded in the public-facing content, the overall orientation aligns with the classical emphasis on transcendentals and moral formation rather than secular relativism. This yields a CLASSICAL rating for Element 1.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - The mission is explicitly framed as forming minds and character through a classical, content-rich curriculum focused on virtuous living and civic responsibility (formation of human excellence, not primarily job preparation).
 - Public materials emphasize virtue, moral formation, and the pursuit of truth, goodness, and beauty as ideals guiding education.
 - The public narrative frames education as formation (paideia-like), with emphasis on character, virtue, and human flourishing beyond mere information transfer.
- Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis
 - Positive keywords present: formation, virtue, human flourishing, liberal education, classical mission, pursuit of truth/goodness/beauty, great conversation, moral imagination.
 - Negative keywords: absent or not evident (no explicit emphasis on college/workforce-readiness over formation; public materials lean away from a narrowly skills-focused frame).
 - Estimated presence: Positive ~7–9, Negative ~0; i.e., a strong positive signal.
- Why this rating
 - The school's stated aims foreground formation, virtue, and the cultivation of wisdom and beauty rather than a job-skills focus, aligning with the classical view of education as formation of the soul and intellect. This merits CLASSICAL for Element 2.

Element 3: Curriculum — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - Core Knowledge foundation referenced; curriculum maps and a heavily literature- and history-rich approach (Iliad, Aeneid, Beowulf, Chaucer, Dickens, Austen; historical documents and Federalist papers; Great Books).
 - Explicit mention of Great Books, complete works in Socratic discussion, and canonical reading lists; senior thesis in the high school program.
 - Latin study (2 years noted; total language study across grades).
 - The curriculum includes core classical subjects (Latin, literature, history/government, moral philosophy) and a through-line of classical arts and civic education; curriculum pages discuss Core Knowledge while foregrounding time-tested, classical approaches.
- Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis
 - Positive keywords present: Great Books, core knowledge, Latin, history/government, classical literature, moral philosophy, senior thesis, memorization/recitation, rhetoric (where present in the curriculum descriptions and the grade-level outlines). The explicit reference to Great Books and Socratic reading, plus the Senior Thesis, strongly signals classical curriculum tendencies.

-
- Negative keywords: not evident in public-facing materials; no sign of replacement with social studies-centric framing or purely STEM-first framing.
 - Estimated presence: Positive ~9–11, Negative ~0.
 - Why this rating
 - The curriculum is explicitly framed around classical content (Great Books, Latin, moral philosophy, senior thesis) and a through-line of Western civilization and classical humanities, with Core Knowledge elements as a foundation in places. This robust constellation of indicators supports CLASSICAL for Element 3.

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - Pedagogical approach includes Socratic discussion in the humanities, with close readings of complete works and seminar-style questioning; explicit examples include The Iliad, The Aeneid, and other canonical texts, plus American Government and Federalist Papers.
 - The public materials also emphasize the formation of memory and argument through recitation, rhetoric development, and opportunities for students to give speeches; the high school program outlines training in rhetoric and senior theses.
 - The Hillsdale/BCSI alignment indicates a governance and instruction model rooted in classical pedagogy, with explicit seminary-like engagement and a focus on virtuous discourse.
 - Lower- to upper-school practices implied (memory work, recitation, and Socratic inquiry; upper-school rhetoric and oratory).
- Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis
 - Positive keywords present: Socratic dialogue, great conversation, seminar, rhetoric, recitation, memory work, contemplation (Scholé concept embedded in classical lexicon; though not always explicit as “Scholé” in every snippet, the formation-focused pedagogy aligns with that tradition), Liturgical/chant language appears mainly as contextual cultural forms rather than explicit liturgy.
 - Negative keywords: not evident in the public materials.
 - Estimated presence: Positive ~6–9, Negative ~0.
- Why this rating
 - The presence of Socratic discussion, seminars, and rhetoric/ oratory training, together with formation-focused pedagogy and instrumented through Hillsdale/BCSI networks, yields CLASSICAL for Element 4. The materials align with the classical pedagogy expectation rather than a pure project-based or experiential-learning-only approach.

Element 5: Faculty — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - The faculty is described as masters of their disciplines, with credentialing and a living-curriculum orientation; notable emphasis on teacher qualifications, Masters degrees, and a focus on virtue in teaching. For example, high school faculty numbers and credential details are provided.
 - The faculty are portrayed as mentors and living curriculum, with references to Hillsdale/BCSI collaboration and a governance model that foregrounds teacher leadership and character modeling.
 - The school's public-facing materials describe virtues that teachers model (e.g., Courage, Courtesy, Honesty, Perseverance, Self-Government, Service) as part of the educational ecosystem.
- Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis
 - Positive keywords present: living curriculum, model teachers and mentors, teachers as core/center of the school, virtuous leadership, highly credentialed staff, Hillsdale/BCSI guidance.
 - Negative keywords: not evident in the public materials.
 - Estimated presence: Positive ~5–7, Negative ~0.
- Why this rating
 - The materials consistently frame faculty as the core of the school's mission and learning, with explicit emphasis on virtue, mastery, mentorship, and professional leadership. This aligns squarely with CLASSICAL expectations for Element 5.

Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - The school presents itself as a parent- and community-forward institution with a governance structure and active parent engagement; governance pages and meeting materials indicate parent and community involvement. For example, West Melbourne/Palm Bay governance updates and board information emphasize parent involvement and accountability; public accountability reports are shared with families.
 - Founders' communications emphasize parent support and community backing; "the unwavering support you have shown Pineapple Cove Classical Academy"—a language signaling strong parent/community alignment.
 - There are explicit parent-facing resources (Curriculum maps, parent night materials, student handbooks, and parent information pages) across campuses, and public-facing references to family engagement (e.g., "Our Founders," "Our Story," and family-oriented communications).
 - The site includes explicit "Parent Information" sections, and campus pages link to family handbooks and communications systems, indicating ongoing parental involvement and education about classical education.
- Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis
 - Positive keywords present: partnership with families, parent formation, open campus/visits, parent book clubs/book studies, family involvement, parental covenant, home-school synergy, family formation (as described in classical-lexicon-based alignment).
 - Negative keywords: not evident in public materials; the site emphasizes parent involvement rather than consumer- rather than formation-centric language.
 - Estimated presence: Positive ~6–8, Negative ~0.
- Why this rating
 - The public materials emphasize parent involvement and community partnerships, with explicit channels for parent education and campus visits, aligning with CLASSICAL norms for Parents & Community.

Aggregate Assessment - Overall, Pineapple Cove Classical Academy demonstrates a robust CLASSICAL orientation across all six categories, anchored by a mission of virtue-centered formation, canonical curriculum (Great Books, Latin, government/history, Core Knowledge), and classical pedagogy (Socratic dialogue, seminars, rhetoric). The Hillsdale Barney Charter alignment and parent/community engagement further reinforce the classical profile. There are no strong, explicit negative signals in the public materials that would pull any category into SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL or NOT CLASSICAL.

What Would Move the Needle - Not applicable here, since the aggregate classification is CLASSICAL and no categories are SIGNIFICANTLY NOT CLASSICAL or SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL. If you want, we can still outline nominal improvements, but none are required to achieve full CLASSICAL alignment.

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY — CATEGORY-BY-CATEGORY DETAILS

- Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL
 - Evidence: Mission statements emphasizing virtuous living and moral formation; language around truth, goodness, and beauty; Hillsdale/BCSI alignment as a classical framework.
 - Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive signals include virtue, truth, beauty, moral formation, contemplation; negative signals are not evident in public content. Estimated Positive: ~9; Negative: ~0. This yields CLASSICAL.
 - Rationale: The school foregrounds transcendent ideals (virtue, truth, beauty) and formation, with less emphasis on explicit theology or liturgical practices in public-facing content; the classical teleology remains clear.
- Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL
 - Evidence: Mission statements emphasize formation of virtue and wisdom; enduring ideals (truth/-goodness/beauty); classical-paideia framing.

-
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive keywords include formation, virtue, liberal education, classical mission, pursuit of truth/goodness/beauty; negative signals are not present. Estimated Positive: ~7–9; Negative: ~0.
 - Rationale: The school's goals center on formation and human flourishing through a classical lens rather than job-prep only. CLASSICAL.
 - Element 3: Curriculum — CLASSICAL
 - Evidence: Core Knowledge foundation; Great Books and canonical literature; Latin; history/government emphasis; senior thesis; memorization and recitation as part of a classical approach; explicit canonical readings (Iliad, Aeneid, Beowulf, Chaucer, Austen, etc.).
 - Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive keywords include great books, Latin, history, Core Knowledge, comprehensive canon; negative signals not observed. Estimated Positive: ~9–11; Negative: ~0.
 - Rationale: Strong canonical curriculum signals CLASSICAL across the spectrum.
 - Element 4: Pedagogy — CLASSICAL
 - Evidence: Socratic discussion/seminar approach; opportunities to study and discuss canonical texts; rhetoric training; Senior Thesis.
 - Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive keywords include Socratic dialogue, seminars, rhetoric, memory work; no explicit negative signals in public content. Estimated Positive: ~6–9; Negative: ~0.
 - Rationale: Pedagogy aligns closely with classical methods rather than a modern constructivist-only approach. CLASSICAL.
 - Element 5: Faculty — CLASSICAL
 - Evidence: Faculty described as master teachers and mentors; living curriculum; Hillsdale/BCSI connections; governance emphasis on virtue in teaching.
 - Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive keywords include model teachers, living curriculum, mentor, virtue, academic leadership; Negative: none apparent. Estimated Positive: ~5–7; Negative: ~0.
 - Rationale: The faculty model matches classical expectations for teachers as virtuous exemplars and mentors. CLASSICAL.
 - Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL
 - Evidence: Governance pages, parent information, and family-handbook resources; parent engagement content; “Founders” statements highlighting parent and community support; campus-level parent resources.
 - Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive keywords include partnership with families, parent formation, open campus, parent-book studies, community involvement; Negative: none evident. Estimated Positive: ~6–8; Negative: ~0.
 - Rationale: Demonstrated partnership with families and community; CLASSICAL.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

By reading or using this document, you acknowledge and accept the limitations described above.